

Job Hunting Platforms & Strategy for Luke

All platforms, job types, and strategy for a production-grade multi-agent AI engineer. **Market context:** Agentic AI job postings grew **280% in 2026**. Salaries for AI Agent Engineers range **\$150K-\$450K** entry to principal. Talent shortage is acute.

Job Types Luke Should Target

Job Title	Why It Fits Luke	Typical Rate
AI Agent Engineer	Building production multi-agent systems — literally what Hermes Cortex does every day. 5+ stateful agents, tool-using, cron-driven.	\$80-200/hr freelance / \$150K-\$320K FTE
AI Agent Architect	Designing agent orchestration, governance loops, tool routing, memory systems, MCP servers. This is the "big picture" version of what Luke architected.	\$120-250/hr freelance / \$220K-\$450K FTE
LLM Observability / AI Reliability Engineer	Langfuse deployment with ClickHouse, trace evaluation, cost tracking, quality gates, model health monitoring. This is Luke's most unique differentiator — most applicants don't have hands-on Langfuse production experience.	\$90-180/hr freelance
Forward Deployed AI Engineer	Custom AI infrastructure for clients — shipping real systems, not demos. Hermes Cortex is a portfolio piece that proves Luke ships.	\$100-200/hr freelance
MCP Server Developer	Building tool servers for AI agents. Niche, growing fast, high rates. Luke has built MCP servers for the Hermes fleet.	\$100-200/hr freelance
AI Infrastructure / MLOps Engineer	Docker, nginx reverse proxy, Ollama self-hosting, SSL, fail2ban, CI/CD for AI services. Standard DevOps but applied to AI — rare combination.	\$70-150/hr freelance
AI Automation Engineer	Cron-driven auto-remediation, health watchdogs, alert pipelines, self-healing infrastructure. Luke runs 40+ crons in production.	\$60-125/hr freelance
Senior Full-Stack AI Developer	Next.js dashboards (Cortex Dashboard) + Python agent backends + nginx deployment. Full-stack AI is in high demand.	\$80-180/hr freelance

Platforms to Use (Ranked by Fit)

Freelance Marketplaces

Rank	Platform	Why for Luke	Commission	Entry Difficulty	Job Volume
1	Upwork	Largest volume — 2,500+ AI jobs live at any time. Already has a daily scanner cron set up.	5-20% sliding	Easy	Very High
2	Toptal	Top 3% screening → enterprise clients, premium rates (\$100-200/hr). Worth the 2-3 week vetting process.	0% to freelancer	Hard (3-stage vetting)	Medium
3	Contra	0% commission — Luke keeps everything. Growing platform for AI/tech freelancers.	0%	Medium	Medium
4	Freelancer.com	Volume competitor to Upwork. Dedicated AI Agents job category.	5-20%	Easy	High
5	Gun.io	Vetted developer marketplace. Matches for ongoing engagements with funded startups.	Blended into client rate	Medium-Hard	Medium
6	Arc.dev	Staff augmentation for AI roles. Strong in EU and US markets.	0% to freelancer	Medium	Medium
7	Lemon.io	Vetted devs matched to startups. Quick turnaround.	0% to freelancer	Medium	Medium
8	WorkGenius	Pre-vetted AI engineers matched to enterprise projects. High quality bar.	0% to freelancer	Hard	Low

Full-Time & Contract Job Boards

Rank	Platform	Why for Luke	Salary Range
1	AgenticCareers.co	Dedicated AI agent job board — 568 open positions globally. Every listing here is relevant.	\$150K-\$450K
2	LinkedIn	Agentic AI jobs grew 280% in 2026. Set alerts for: "AI Agent Engineer", "Multi-Agent Systems", "LangGraph", "Agentic AI", "LLM Observability"	\$130K-\$350K
3	Indeed	Broad volume. "AI Agent Engineer" returns hundreds of live listings. Good for discovering companies hiring.	\$120K-\$320K
4	ClawJobs.cc	Niche AI agent job board. Curated listings, \$150K-\$350K+ salaries.	\$150K-\$350K+
5	ZipRecruiter	\$60-\$125/hr freelance AI agent roles. High volume.	\$60-125/hr
6	Glassdoor	Salary transparency. Search "Senior AI Engineer" + "Agent".	\$130K-\$280K
7	Robert Half	Contract and temp AI roles through staffing agencies. Good for quick placements.	\$70-150/hr

Niche & Side Opportunities

Opportunity	Platform	How It Works	Rate
Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork	Create fixed-price service listings — e.g. "Langfuse LLM Observability Setup: Full deployment, trace wiring, eval dashboards — \$2,500, 5-day delivery"	\$2K-\$10K/project
Kaggle Bounties	Kaggle	Solve ML challenges for prize money. Low volume but high signal for portfolio.	\$1K-\$100K
HuggingFace Bounties	HuggingFace	Community challenges and paid model-building tasks.	Variable
Mindrift	Mindrift	Train AI models as a domain expert. Flexible hours.	\$15-100/hr
Technical Consulting	Direct / LinkedIn	Advise startups on AI agent architecture. Build once, consult many times.	\$150-300/hr
Open Source Sponsorships	GitHub Sponsors / Polar	Companies sponsor maintainers of Hermes Cortex or related open-source tools.	Variable

Recommended Strategy (Priority Order)

Phase 1 — Immediate (This Week)

#	Action	Platform	Time
1	Create Upwork Project Catalog listing: "Langfuse LLM Observability Setup — full deployment, trace wiring, evaluation dashboards"	Upwork Services	30 min
2	Apply to the 3 active multi-agent listings already identified in the strategy doc	Upwork	20 min each
3	Create AgenticCareers.co profile — upload CV, set alerts for "AI Agent Engineer" + "Remote"	AgenticCareers	20 min

Phase 2 — This Month

#	Action	Platform	Time
4	Apply to Toptal (2-3 week vetting, worth it for premium rates — \$100-200/hr)	Toptal	3 hrs total
5	Create Contra profile with Hermes Cortex as portfolio centerpiece	Contra	30 min
6	Set LinkedIn job alerts for: "AI Agent Engineer", "Multi-Agent Systems", "LangGraph", "LLM Observability", "Agentic AI"	LinkedIn Jobs	10 min
7	Set Indeed + ZipRecruiter alerts for same keywords	Indeed , ZipRecruiter	10 min

Phase 3 — Ongoing

#	Action	Cadence
8	Upwork daily scan — already automated via <code>upwork-job-scanner</code> cron (every 08:00 to Telegram)	Daily
9	Check AgenticCareers.co + ClawJobs.cc weekly — small enough that listings stay fresh and less competition	Weekly
10	Build 2-3 portfolio case studies from Hermes Cortex: architecture diagram, Langfuse dashboard screenshots, uptime/reliability stats. Portfolio beats CV every time.	This month
11	Write a technical blog post — "How I Built a Production Multi-Agent System with Langfuse Observability" on Medium/Dev.to. Clients will find Luke, not the other way around.	This month

Market Context (2026)

Metric	Value
Agentic AI job posting growth (YoY)	280%
Job postings mentioning agentic AI skills (2024)	986% increase
Active AI Agent Engineer roles	~90,000 US listings
Median total comp (AI Agent Engineer)	\$140K
Senior / Principal comp	\$220K-\$450K
LangGraph mentioned in job postings	34.3%
Enterprise projects including AI agents	60%
Companies that say they need agentic AI talent	77%

Sources: Stanford AI Index 2026, AgenticCareers Salary Database, KORE1 Hiring Survey, LinkedIn data.

Companion Files

File	Content
upwork-job-strategy.md	Detailed Upwork strategy — categories, active listings, pitch angles
upwork-cover-letter-template.md	Ready-to-use proposal text